Yingjin Song

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Research Topics

LLM, VLM, Agentic RL, Mechanistic Interpretability, Efficient Reasoning, Benchmarking & Evaluation.

Education

Utrecht University, Utrecht, the Netherlands **July 2022 – now**
Ph.D. Candidate in Computer Science *Supervisor: Prof. Albert Gatt, Dr. Denis Paperno*

The University of Melbourne, Melbourne, Australia **July 2019 – June 2021**
Master of Computer Science (with Distinction) *Supervisor: Dr. Daniel Beck*

The Australian National University, Canberra, Australia **July 2016 – June 2019**
Bachelor of Information Technology

Publications

- **Yingjin Song**, Denis Paperno and Albert Gatt (2026). Who Is Left of Whom? Tracing Spatial Evidence and Role Binding in Relative-Position Reasoning. In *AIW at COLM2026*. [link]
- **Yingjin Song**, Yupei Du, Denis Paperno and Albert Gatt (2025). Burn After Reading: Do Multimodal Large Language Models Truly Capture Order of Events in Image Sequences? In *Findings of ACL 2025*. [link]
- Yupei Du, **Yingjin Song**, Hugh Mee Wong, Daniil Ignatev, Albert Gatt and Dong Nguyen (2025). Disentangling the Roles of Representation and Selection in Data Pruning. *In Main Conference of ACL 2025*. [link]
- **Yingjin Song**, Denis Paperno and Albert Gatt (2024). Context-aware Visual Storytelling with Visual Prefix Tuning and Contrastive Learning. In *INLG 2024*. [link]
- **Yingjin Song** and Daniel Beck (2023). Modeling Emotion Dynamics in Song Lyrics with State Space Models. In *Transactions of the Association for Computational Linguistics (2023)*. [link]

Professional Service and Teaching

- Instructor of NLP Course for Dutch Government (Rijksoverheid) Data Trainees (July 2026)
- Reviewer of ACL Rolling Review (2024 -), COLING (2024 - 2025), CoNLL (2025 -)
- Lecturer and TA of *Transformers: Applications in Language and Communication*: 2025 - 2027
- TA of *Methods in Artificial Intelligence Research*: 2022 - 2026
- TA of *Computational Thinking and Programming with Python*: 2023, 2026
- TA of *Responsible Data Science*: 2024 - 2025
- Daily supervisor for 10+ AI/CS BSc/MSc thesis students: 2023 - 2026

Work Experience

Sina Weibo Corp. **December 2018 – February 2019**
Data Science Intern *Beijing, China*

∗ Assisted in cleaning data, feature engineering, and utilizing ML models to optimize ad pricing strategies by predicting click-through and conversion rates.
∗ Developed an automated testing framework for migrating unit tests, ensuring ML pipeline compatibility, and designed a web page to visualize daily testing reports for stakeholders.

Lenovo Group Ltd. **December 2016 – February 2017**
Server Engineer Intern *Beijing, China*

∗ Assisted with engineers to maintain and solve issues in server clusters;
∗ Performed fault diagnosis and arranged on-site technicians and managed customers' data using SQL.